

January 9, 2025

Penske Logistics LLC
915 East 230th Street
Carson, California

Re: DCM Supply Chain and Logistics Management Trainee Warehouse (Req ID: 2416651)

Dear Hiring Manager:

I'm currently seeking full-time work in Supply Chain Management Logistics immediately after my expected graduation from the Eller College of Management Business School at the University of Arizona in May 2025. After reading the details of your job description, I believe I can assume the responsibilities listed in warehouse operations, demand-chain management, and continuous improvement efforts at Penske Logistics as a Logistics Trainee.

As a Business Major in Operations and Supply Chain Management, with a Minor in Global Business, my supply chain and operations training and work includes notable domestic and international metropolitan locations such as Los Angeles, Tucson, Dublin, Ireland, and Nogales, Mexico, with the following examples that highlight my experience:

Growth/Customer Experience: As part of my Global Business education, I worked and studied in Dublin, Ireland, as a study abroad student in the Dublin Business School. I analyzed market trends across key industries for global companies, assessed corporate communication strategies, and developed strategic reports for corporate planning and data-driven decision-making. Being an analytical thinker, I enjoyed uncovering the unique business perspectives offered through data analysis. My Dublin international internship experience gave me a hands-on perspective of business operations in Europe, working closely with the CEO of my company, who selected me to attend a multi-national technology and business conference held locally in Dublin, for deeper learning and immersion.

Fleet/Assets: In Nogales, Mexico, I observed and learned through my practicum Eller Business School experience that concluded with a successful team presentation, discussing border logistics between the United States and Mexico for inbound and outbound shipments, and the various regulatory requirements involved.

People: My varsity sports club experiences have utilized my team leadership skills and enhanced my critical thinking regarding how to address business problems. I joined the Arizona Esports Program, where I rapidly found a thriving community I could be a part of, while also competing on a team as a varsity student-athlete. I was able to interact with fellow students from diverse backgrounds who I would not have had an opportunity to meet otherwise. This extracurricular activity in college helped me to grow as a leader and to build a culture of inclusivity and diversity, while also focusing on team goals in a highly competitive and fast environment. I have learned multiple languages (English, Hungarian, Mandarin), and my pan-national view of the global community embraces all cultures and customs and has allowed me to understand the viewpoints of people from other countries and backgrounds with compassion and curiosity.

Operations: My previous summer jobs in warehousing logistics in leading companies involved understanding operations through taking various shifts, including working through night shifts, and using physical strength. To be successful and prepare for the physical demands of moving merchandise, I drew from my training playing Waterpolo during my high school years, a game involving complex strategies and techniques, which required

excellent personal physical fitness and practice to excel in. I have learned a great deal from the game from Croatian Olympian coaches, including the need for personal discipline and self-sacrifice. I have made good friends in the sport because I have played on an organized club team for several years which practiced four to five days a week, and participated in competitive tournaments all over Southern California. The sport has also taught me the importance of maintaining a balance between academics and extracurricular activities, both in terms of personal development and time-management skills. Waterpolo practices were normally at night, which required me to complete school homework and prepare for tests in a highly organized and efficient manner to remain ahead academically.

Safety/Finance: At two leading companies, Lowe's and Amazon, I enhanced supply chain logistics and inventory management, optimizing the warehouse layout and high-turn goods flow. I implemented best practices in inventory organization, fostering leadership and teamwork, which streamlined operations and improved efficiency. I ensured that the merchandise was accurately received, stocked, and replenished. I followed proper lifting guidelines to ensure safe moving and placement of merchandise. I acquired foundational supply chain logistics skills, contributing to the setup of a new warehouse transportation hub. I was able to enhance shipment routing efficiency, and developed my leadership skills through diverse team roles, optimizing overall operational success. As a Receiver/Stocker, I helped provide and deliver the right products to our customers by safely unloading merchandise from incoming freight, moving it to the sales floor, and stocking departments. When needed, I replaced damaged shelving and kept the backroom organized. Additionally, I organized merchandise and top stock to set up my store for sales success.

In business operations and implementations, I seek to integrate sustainable supply chain management best practices to future global businesses where I will contribute. I'm eager to learn about the cutting-edge technologies and DCM software tools that Penske Logistics is using in the field. I would like to better understand how to optimize operational success factors in a responsible environmental, social, and economic practice, in supply chain processes and in their impacts. Therefore gaining hands-on experience in a distribution center management operation, and to learn and implement Lean processes, inventory management, and other key focus areas that I covered during my undergraduate education in my Major, would provide me with an invaluable opportunity for connecting my training with real-world practical experience in the next phase of my career. Working as a Logistics Trainee at Penske Logistics would be a tremendous opportunity after graduation, to continue my professional journey being involved in critical areas of logistics management at Penske.

With my commitment to contributing to purposeful innovation in a value-driven workplace, I strive for excellence in every effort I engage. I would very much appreciate meeting with your recruiter to better answer any questions you may have regarding my skills and qualifications.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Thomas Schlaerth '25

Operations & Supply Chain Management and Global Business
Eller College of Business Management, University of Arizona
Tucson, Arizona

Email: thomasschlaerth@arizona.edu

Cell: (310) 245-1927